考研英语（一）

词汇与阅读讲义 · 样章 01

Technology: When Innovation Creates New Problems

母题：Innovation vs. Regulation · 创新与规制

本章不是“科技类单词表”。

它训练你读懂一种英语一反复出现的论证：新技术带来收益，但也产生旧制度未能预见的新问题。

本章目标 掌握 14 个可跨科技、商业、法律与公共政策迁移的核心词/词块；读懂“收益—副作用—证据—规制回应”的论证链；完成一篇自编的考研英语一风格阅读。

说明：除“题源背景”外，本章英文例句、短文与练习均为讲义自编，用于模拟考研英语（一）常见文风与认知负荷。

1 先建立母题：技术进步为什么会进入公共争论？

考研英语一并不要求你成为技术专家。更常见的阅读任务，是让你跟随作者观察：**一项技术怎样从“有用”走向“有争议”**，以及作者如何使用证据限制自己的结论。

innovation	adoption	efficiency	disruption	concern	regulation	accountability
创新出现	被社会采用	产生效率收益	打破原有秩序	引发担忧	制度回应	责任被追问

近年真题中的对应形态：2024 英语一 Text 3 讨论 AI 生成图像与艺术家版权争议；2025 英语一 Text 3 讨论流媒体价格、商业模式与网络盗版。这两篇题材不同，但都可以抽象成“技术/平台变化 → 新收益或新行为 → 制度与责任问题”。

阅读时先问的四个问题 What changed? 谁获益/受损？ 作者拿什么证据支持判断？ 最终主张的是禁止、调整、监管，还是保持谨慎?

2 本章词汇网络

功能	核心词 / 词块
创新扩散	innovation, adoption, efficiency
问题生成	disruption, concern, consequence
论证判断	claim, evidence, assume, account for
制度回应	address, regulate, subject to, accountability

3 核心词汇组 1

innovation *n.*

考研核心义：创新；新方法/新制度的引入。考研文章中常不只是“发明”，还包含把新做法带入现实系统。

词族：innovate v. / innovative adj. / innovator n.

常见结构：technological innovation; encourage innovation; innovation in sth

1. Technological innovation can lower the cost of producing information while making it harder to decide who should be paid for the content on which new systems depend.
2. The value of an innovation is often judged not by its novelty alone but by whether it improves an existing practice without creating greater costs elsewhere.

阅读提示：看到 innovation，不要自动等于“进步”。作者可能随后讨论它的限制、代价或治理问题。

adoption *n.*

考研核心义：采用；采纳。用于技术、政策、制度、做法进入实际使用。

词族：adopt v. / adopter n.

常见结构：the adoption of technology/policy; widespread/rapid adoption

1. Rapid adoption of a new platform may occur before researchers have enough evidence to estimate its long-term effects.

2. Businesses often favor early adoption when the expected gains are clear, even if the wider social consequences remain uncertain.

阅读提示：adoption 描述“进入使用”，不等于证明该技术有效、安全或公平。

易错点：不要只记“收养”。在科技、政策、商业文中，“采用”更常见。

efficiency *n.*

考研核心义：效率；以较少时间、成本或资源完成任务的能力。

词族：efficient adj. / efficiently adv.

常见结构：improve/increase efficiency; efficiency gains; energy efficiency

1. Automation may improve efficiency by removing repetitive tasks, yet the resulting savings do not necessarily reach workers or consumers.

2. A policy designed solely around efficiency can overlook values that are difficult to measure, such as fairness, trust, or cultural continuity.

阅读提示：考研阅读常用 efficiency 与 value/fairness/quality 形成张力：更高效不必然等于整体更好。

disruption *n.*

考研核心义：扰乱；颠覆；对既有行业、制度或日常活动造成显著改变。

词族：disrupt v. / disruptive adj.

常见结构：cause disruption; market disruption; disruptive technology

1. Digital tools have disrupted industries whose business models depended on controlling access to scarce information.

2. Disruption is sometimes celebrated as evidence of progress, but those who bear the transition costs may view the same change very differently.

阅读提示：注意作者是否把 disruption 当成积极的“创新颠覆”，还是中性的/负面的“秩序受扰”。

4 核心词汇组 2

concern *n./v.*

考研核心义：担忧；值得关注的问题；涉及、关系到。

词族：concerned adj. / concerning prep.

常见结构：raise concerns about; growing concern; be concerned with/about

1. Privacy concerns become more serious when users cannot tell how their data are collected or whether they can refuse further use.

2. The debate concerns not only what a technology can do, but also who is entitled to decide how it should be used.

阅读提示：concern 作名词常指“问题/忧虑”；作动词 concern sth 可表示“涉及”。

易错点：be concerned about = 担心；be concerned with = 涉及/关注，语义不同。

consequence *n.*

考研核心义：结果；后果，常指某一行为或变化带来的后续影响。

词族：consequent adj. / consequently adv.

常见结构：have consequences for; unintended consequences; long-term consequence

1. Regulation introduced after a crisis may solve an immediate problem while producing unintended consequences for smaller firms.

2. The long-term consequences of widespread AI use may depend less on the technology itself than on the institutions built around it.

阅读提示：看到 consequence 要寻找因果链：前文什么变化导致了后文什么结果。

claim *v./n.*

考研核心义：声称；主张。表示某人把一个命题提出为真，但文本本身并未因此证明它。

词族：claimant n. / claimed adj.

常见结构：claim that...; claim to do/be; make/support/challenge a claim

1. Platform companies often claim that stricter rules would slow innovation, but such claims need to be tested against evidence from regulated markets.

2. The claim that consumers always prefer convenience assumes that other values, such as privacy, matter less.

阅读提示：claim 是“观点归属”信号。读到 X claims that P，只能确定“X 提出 P”，不能直接推出作者接受 P。

易错点：不要把 claim 自动翻成“断言是假的”；它只表示“提出为真但尚需证明”。

evidence *n.*

考研核心义：证据；支持或反驳某一判断的信息。通常为不可数名词。

词族：evident adj. / evidently adv.

常见结构：evidence for/of; evidence that...; a body of evidence

1. Evidence that a new tool saves time does not by itself show that it improves the quality of the decisions made with it.

2. When the available evidence is limited, a cautious conclusion is more defensible than a sweeping prediction.

阅读提示：阅读题常考“证据能支持多强的结论”。有 evidence for A，不等于足以证明更强的 B。

易错点：通常不说 an evidence；可说 a piece of evidence。

5 核心词汇组 3

assume *v.*

考研核心义：假定；在缺少充分证明时把某命题暂时当作真。

词族：assumption n. / assumed adj.

常见结构：assume that...; assume responsibility/control; underlying assumption

1. Policies that assume all users understand complex privacy settings may fail precisely where protection is most needed.

2. The argument assumes that lower prices will automatically produce greater public benefit, an assumption that may not hold in every market.

阅读提示：assume 常暴露论证的“隐含前提”。推断题和作者态度题里，这类前提很值得找。

account for *phr. v.*

考研核心义：解释；说明……的原因；（数量上）占……比例。

词族：account n./v.

常见结构：account for a difference/change; account for X percent

1. Lower production costs account for only part of the price decline; stronger competition has also played a role.

2. No single factor can fully account for the public’s changing attitude toward automated decision-making.

阅读提示：先看宾语：如果后接 difference/change 等现象，常译“解释”；如果后接比例/份额，常译“占”。

address *v.*

考研核心义：处理、应对某个问题；正式讨论某个议题。

词族：address n.

常见结构：address a problem/issue/concern; address the question of...

1. New rules may address the most visible abuses without resolving the deeper incentives that created them.

2. Any serious debate about AI governance must address the question of who remains responsible when automated systems make consequential errors.

阅读提示：考研熟词义重点：address + problem/issue 通常不是“发表演说”，而是“处理/应对”。

regulate *v.*

考研核心义：通过规则、法律或制度加以管理、约束。

词族：regulation n. / regulatory adj. / regulator n.

常见结构：regulate an industry; government regulation; regulatory framework

1. The challenge is not simply whether to regulate emerging technology, but how to design rules that reduce harm without freezing useful experimentation.

2. Industries that regulate themselves may respond more quickly than governments, although self-regulation can fail when commercial incentives are too strong.

阅读提示：regulation 不等于 ban。文章可能讨论 light-touch regulation、self-regulation、stricter rules 等不同强度。

6 核心词汇组 4

subject to *phrase*

考研核心义：受……影响/约束；须经……；取决于……条件。

词族：subject n./adj./v.

常见结构：be subject to regulation/change/review; subject to approval

1. Companies operating in sensitive sectors are subject to rules that do not apply to ordinary consumer products.

2. The apparent benefits of a new system are subject to revision as better data become available.

阅读提示：subject to 常表示“受制于/须经/可能遭受”，需要根据宾语确定译法。

易错点：不要机械翻译为“主题”。

accountability *n.*

考研核心义：问责；对决定、行为及其后果承担解释和责任的制度状态。

词族：accountable adj.

常见结构：accountability for; hold sb accountable; be accountable to sb

1. Automation can blur accountability when a harmful decision results from the interaction of software, data, managers, and outside contractors.

2. Clear accountability matters because people are less able to challenge a decision when no institution accepts responsibility for it.

阅读提示：它比 responsibility 更强调“谁需要向谁解释并承担后果”的制度关系。

7 把词连成论证：四组高频关系

claim ↔ evidence claim 提出命题；evidence 决定这个命题获得多大支持。
A company may claim that a tool is safer, while the evidence shows only that it is faster.

assumption ↔ conclusion assumption 是论证的前提；conclusion 是在这些前提与证据上推出的结果。
If the assumption changes, the same evidence may support a different conclusion.

efficiency ↔ value efficiency 是一种评价尺度，不等同于 fairness, quality, trust 等全部价值。
A more efficient system may still be rejected if it is seen as unfair or impossible to challenge.

regulation ↔ innovation 二者不是天然对立；真实文章常讨论“规则设计是否能同时降低风险并保留试验空间”。
The question is often how to regulate innovation, not whether society must choose one and abandon the other.

一个考研式长句怎么读

> Although firms often claim that strict regulation discourages innovation, the evidence is less decisive than this argument suggests, partly because industries subject to clear rules may invest more confidently when legal uncertainty is reduced.

主干：the evidence is less decisive than this argument suggests

让步：Although firms often claim...

原因：partly because industries ... may invest more confidently...

关键判断：作者没有说 regulation 一定促进 innovation；作者只是在削弱“严格监管必然压制创新”这一强命题。

8 阅读训练：Rules Can Be Part of Innovation

以下短文为本讲义自编，篇幅、句法与论证密度参照考研英语（一）阅读训练需求；并非历年真题原文。

① New technologies are often introduced with a familiar promise: they will make an existing activity faster, cheaper, or easier. Such gains can encourage rapid adoption, particularly when users feel the benefit immediately while the costs are delayed or spread across society. Yet this pattern also creates a problem for public debate. Efficiency is easy to observe; the consequences that emerge later are not.

② Consider automated systems used to recommend content, screen job applicants, or detect fraud. Their developers may claim that these tools improve consistency by replacing subjective human judgment with data-driven rules. There is evidence that automation can reduce some forms of error. But this does not establish that the systems are neutral. A model may reproduce patterns contained in historical data, and people affected by its decisions may have little idea how to challenge them.

③ The usual response is to call for regulation. Critics then warn that regulation will slow innovation, raise costs, and protect established firms from new competitors. That concern deserves attention, but it rests on an assumption that rules only restrict economic activity. In practice, clear standards can also reduce uncertainty. Firms may be more willing to invest when they know what information they may collect, what decisions require human review, and who will be accountable when something goes wrong.

④ The more useful question, therefore, is not whether innovation should be regulated, but what kind of regulation can address genuine risks without freezing experimentation. Rules should be subject to review as evidence improves, especially in rapidly changing fields. This approach accepts that regulation can have unintended consequences while rejecting the idea that leaving a technology entirely unregulated is the only way to preserve progress.

Questions 21-25

21. According to Paragraph 1, why can rapid adoption complicate public debate?

A. Users tend to reject benefits that cannot be measured.

B. Immediate gains may be clearer than delayed social costs.

C. New technologies usually become cheaper over time.

D. Public debate begins only after a technology fails.

22. The author suggests that evidence about automation

A. proves that automated systems are more neutral than people.

B. shows that historical data contain no systematic bias.

C. supports some benefits without settling the broader issue of fairness.

D. is too weak to justify any practical use of automated tools.

23. The word “assumption” in Paragraph 3 refers to the idea that regulation

A. mainly limits economic activity.

B. reduces legal uncertainty for firms.

C. should focus on established companies.

D. makes investors more willing to experiment.

24. The author argues that clear standards may encourage investment because they

A. eliminate the possibility of costly mistakes.

B. make the legal environment more predictable.

C. allow firms to avoid responsibility for automated decisions.

D. prevent regulators from changing their rules.

25. Which of the following best summarizes the passage?

A. Regulation and innovation are necessarily in conflict.

B. Automation should be restricted until all risks are known.

C. Effective regulation can manage risks while leaving room for innovation.

D. The social costs of technology always outweigh efficiency gains.

9 词汇迁移训练

A. 语境选义

1. Several factors may account for the decline in newspaper subscriptions.

account for 最接近：A 占有 B 解释 C 负责付款 D 记录

2. The proposal is subject to review by an independent committee.

subject to 最接近：A 作为主题 B 提交给 C 须经/受制于 D 反对

3. The report addresses concerns about the use of personal data.

addresses 最接近：A 写地址 B 向……致辞 C 处理/回应 D 邮寄

4. The company claims that the system can reduce errors by 30 percent.

claims 在这里首先告诉我们：A 数字一定可靠 B 公司提出了一个需要证据支持的命题 C 作者赞成公司 D 系统已通过监管

B. 选择最合适的词完成句子

词库：innovation / adoption / efficiency / disruption / concern / consequence / evidence / assume / regulation / accountability

1. The rapid _____ of remote-work tools changed office routines before many firms had agreed on long-term policies.

2. A major _____ about automated hiring is that applicants may not know why they were rejected.

3. The available _____ supports a modest improvement, not the dramatic gains promised in advertisements.

4. Policymakers should not _____ that every consumer has the time or expertise to read complex terms of service.

5. Clear _____ is difficult when responsibility is divided among a developer, a client company, and an outside data provider.

6. Greater _____ may reduce costs without improving the fairness of a decision-making system.

C. 句子判断：作者说得有多强？

Evidence suggests that the policy may reduce waste.

这句话是否等于 “The policy has been proved to eliminate waste.”？说明差别。

The company claims that its model is unbiased.

仅根据这句话，能否判断作者相信该模型无偏？为什么？

The system is subject to regular review.

这说明系统“已经失败”了吗？subject to 在这里表达什么制度关系？

10 答案与解析

阅读 21-25

21. B 第一段直接建立“immediate benefit vs. delayed/spread costs”的时间差。命题点不是技术本身，而是信息可见性的差异。

22. C 第二段先承认 evidence 支持“reduce some forms of error”，随后用 But 限制结论：这不足以证明 neutral。典型的“证据强度 < 结论强度”。

23. A 原句为 “it rests on an assumption that rules only restrict economic activity”。assumption 的内容由 that 从句直接给出。

24. B clear standards → reduce uncertainty → know what is allowed/required → invest more confidently。核心是可预期性，而非“消除错误”。

25. C 全文并非支持全面监管或全面放任，而是主张寻找能 address risks 且不 freeze experimentation 的规则。

词汇迁移

A：1-B；2-C；3-C；4-B。

B：1 adoption；2 concern；3 evidence；4 assume；5 accountability；6 efficiency。

C 参考：

① 不等于。suggests / may 都限制了结论强度；reduce 也弱于 eliminate。

② 不能。claim 只完成观点归属：公司提出该命题。作者是否接受，要看后续证据和评价。

③ 不说明失败。be subject to regular review 表示“须接受/受制于定期审查”。

本章闭卷复盘

- 能否不用中文提示解释 claim 与 evidence 的关系?
- 能否分别给 account for 写出“解释”和“占比”两个句子?
- 看到 address a concern，能否立即排除“地址/演说”义?
- 能否解释为什么 efficiency 高不等于 value 一定高?
- 能否用 3 句话复述本章阅读的论证链，而不照抄原文?

11 编写依据与来源说明

题源结构参考：

- 2024 英语一 Text 3：MIT Technology Review 文章，主题涉及 AI 生成图像、艺术家与版权/规制争议。真题题源信息由公开真题整理页交叉核对。
- 2025 英语一 Text 3：Bloomberg 文章 “Streaming Service Costs Drive New Era of Hollywood Piracy”，主题涉及流媒体商业模式、价格与盗版。
- 2016-2026 题源汇总显示英语一阅读持续来自 Financial Times、The Times、The Guardian、Scientific American、Science、Nature、MIT Technology Review 等面向大众的新闻、评论与科普来源。

词义与语法核对：

- Cambridge Dictionary: claim - “say that something is true ... although you cannot prove it ...”; 同页列出 claim that / claim to 等结构。
- Cambridge Grammar: reporting verbs + that-clause，包括 claim, assume, suggest 等，用于观点与命题归属。
- Cambridge Dictionary: assume - “accept something as true without question or proof”。
- 其他词条的具体释义与结构在编写时按 Cambridge/Oxford learner dictionary 的常见用法核对；例句全部重新创作。

公开检索页面（访问日期 2026-09-21）：

https://english-exam.lazynote.cn/kaoyan/paper/2024-english-one/

https://english-exam.lazynote.cn/kaoyan/articles/2025-english-one/

https://elegy.show/english/

https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/english/claim

https://dictionary.cambridge.org/grammar/british-grammar/that-clause

https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/assume

样章设计原则 词不是按“科技类名词”堆在一起，而是按一个可复用的考研母题组织。每个词至少进入一次论证句；核心词随后在阅读与练习里再次出现。